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flydubai and
Etihad cancel
flights amid
tensions

DUBAI
BY LEKSHMY PAVITHRAN
Assistant Online Editor

Dubai-based airline flydubai has temporarily suspended flights to several destinations amid ongoing regional developments and airspace closures. The airline confirmed that flight suspensions affect five destinations — Iran, Iraq, Israel, Syria and St Petersburg — and will remain in place until June 30. Passengers transiting through Dubai with final destinations in any of these locations will not be accepted for travel from their point of origin until further notice. UAE’s national carrier, Etihad Airways, is also experiencing widespread flight disruptions across the Middle East, citing ongoing regional instability and multiple airspace closures. Several services have been delayed or cancelled, the airline confirmed.

Avoiding airspace
Airlines are now avoiding airspace over Iran, Iraq, Syria, and Israel, rerouting flights over safer regions such as the Caspian Sea, Egypt, and Saudi Arabia, according to flight tracking service FlightRadar24. As a direct result of the airspace situation, Etihad has suspended all flights between Abu Dhabi (AUH) and Tel Aviv (TLV) until July 15 (inclusive). Passengers transiting through Abu Dhabi to connect to cancelled Tel Aviv flights will not be permitted to travel from their original departure point.

US strikes on Iran spark global pleas for diplomacy

UAE URGES IMMEDIATE DE-ESCALATION AFTER THREE IRAN NUCLEAR SITES HIT

ABU DHABI

The UAE has voiced deep concern over escalating tensions in the region, particularly following the targeting of Iranian nuclear facilities, urging an immediate halt to any further escalation to prevent the situation from spiralling into deeper instability. This comes after the US military struck three sites in Iran early yesterday, inserting itself into Israel’s effort to decapitate Iran’s nuclear programme. In a statement released by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, the UAE emphasised the urgent need to resolve disputes through diplomacy and dialogue. The UAE stressed the importance of pursuing comprehensive frameworks that promote stability, prosperity, and justice across the region. The UAE also renewed its call for the international community to intensify efforts toward a broad and sustainable resolution to what it described as “sensitive and dangerous developments,” warning that continued unrest poses grave risks to both the region and its people.

UN urged to take steps
The ministry urged the United Nations and the UN Security Council to shoulder their responsibilities and take necessary steps to address long-standing crises, now at a critical juncture and increasingly threatening regional and global stability. “The UAE believes that wisdom and responsibility are critical in this moment,”



Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian attends a protest rally in Tehran following the US attacks on three nuclear sites in Iran yesterday.

the statement read, adding that meaningful engagement and negotiation are essential to addressing pivotal challenges. The ministry also stressed the importance of drawing on the region’s past experiences and conflicts, and the lessons they offer in averting further escalation. The Arab League announced that it is following with great concern the developments, expressing its condemnation of any military actions that violate the sovereignty of states. Oman, which was mediating nuclear talks between Washington and Tehran, strongly condemned the US strikes. Saudi

Arabia too expressed “great concern”, while Qatar, host of the biggest US military base in the Middle East, said it feared serious repercussions after the US air strikes. Bahrain, meanwhile, issued a notice to drivers to stay off main roads if possible.

Dangerous escalation
UN Secretary-General Antonio Guterres called the strikes a “dangerous escalation,” as others began chiming in with calls for diplomacy. Russia said it “strongly condemned” the United States’ bombings, calling the attacks “irresponsible” and a “gross viola-

tion of international law”. France also expressed “concern” and called on all parties to “exercise restraint” to avoid greater conflict. China’s foreign ministry said it “strongly condemns” the US strikes, adding that they “escalate tensions in the Middle East”. UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer and German Chancellor Friedrich Merz called on Iran to “return to the negotiating table” over its nuclear ambitions. Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said that he would travel to Moscow for talks with Russian President Vladimir Putin today.

— Agencies
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